

Startup Customer Acquisition Worksheet

A working worksheet for turning customer, offer, channel, conversion, and measurement assumptions into a testable acquisition plan.

Startup Customer Acquisition Worksheet

Before you choose a channel, get clear about the customer you are trying to acquire. This worksheet helps you work through the pieces that usually determine whether acquisition becomes a repeatable process or a string of disconnected campaigns.

Fill this out with real observations where you have them and label assumptions where you do not. You are building a hypothesis you can test, not pretending you already know the answer.

A good acquisition plan should let another person read it and understand who the customer is, what you are offering, where the customer may come from, what happens after the click, and what numbers will tell you whether the process is working.

1. THE CUSTOMER

Primary customer / account:

Situation that creates the need:

Problem they are trying to solve:

What they do today instead:

What makes the problem urgent enough to act?

Where do they usually look for answers?

Who notices the problem? _____ Who decides? _____ Who pays? _____

Typical buying cycle: _____ Existing alternatives:

Questions customers ask:

Objections we hear:

2. THE OFFER

Offer name: _____

Offer in one sentence: _____

What the customer receives: _____

Primary CTA: _____

Next step after CTA: _____

Price / pricing model: _____ Expected customer value:
\$ _____

Proof we can show: _____

Claims that need evidence or qualification: _____

What would make someone choose this instead of doing nothing? _____

What would make someone hesitate? _____

Offer consistency check

- ☐ The campaign promise matches the landing page.
- ☐ The landing page explains the offer before asking for a major commitment.
- ☐ The CTA is specific.
- ☐ The follow-up step is defined before traffic is sent.

3. CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

Write the path from first attention to customer. If a step does not exist, write “missing.”

Stage	Customer action	Our message / experience	Evidence / metric
Discovery			
Interest			
Evaluation			
Conversion			
Onboarding			
Early value			
Retention / referral			

4. ACQUISITION CHANNEL HYPOTHESES

Choose channels because they fit the customer and the buying behavior. Do not treat the table as a checklist of channels you must use.

Channel	Why it fits	Offer / message	Test	Continue / stop rule
Search				
Paid social				
Organic social				
Email				
Referral / partner				
Outbound / sales				
Community / events				
Other: _____				

5. FUNNEL AND CONVERSION MATH

These numbers do not need to be perfect. They need to be explicit enough to reveal when the plan depends on unrealistic assumptions.

Monthly customer goal: _____ Qualified leads goal: _____ Opportunities goal: _____

Lead-to-opportunity rate: _____ % Opportunity-to-customer rate: _____ %

Expected customer value: \$ _____ Maximum sustainable acquisition cost: \$ _____

Planned monthly acquisition spend: \$ _____ Test budget: \$ _____

What has to be true for these numbers to work?

Which number is least certain today?

6. LANDING PAGE AND CONVERSION PLAN

- ☐ The headline says what the offer is and who it is for.
- ☐ The page answers the highest-value questions before the CTA.
- ☐ The CTA is easy to understand.
- ☐ The form asks only for information needed at this stage.
- ☐ Proof is specific and honest.
- ☐ The page works on a phone.
- ☐ The conversion is measured.

Headline: _____

Supporting message: _____

Primary CTA: _____

Proof / objection handling: _____

Form fields: _____

Follow-up owner: _____ Expected response time: _____

Follow-up action: _____

What happens if the lead is not ready? _____

7. MEASUREMENT PLAN

Business question	Event / measure	Tool / source	Owner	Cadence
Who is arriving?				
Who engages?				
Who reaches the CTA?				
Who converts?				
Which leads qualify?				
Which customers stay / expand?				

8. EXPERIMENT LOG

Use one row per meaningful test. Write the hypothesis before you look at the result.

Hypothesis	Change	Primary metric	Test window	Result / decision

9. CUSTOMER FEEDBACK LOOP

Why did customers say yes?

Why did good prospects say no?

What nearly stopped the purchase?

What message or proof helped most?

Which source produced the best-fit customers?

What should change next?

10. BUILD-READY ACQUISITION PLAN

Customer:

Problem / trigger:

Offer:

Primary channel:

Landing page / destination:

Primary conversion:

Metric that matters most:

Next experiment:

What would make us change course:

Sources

Google Analytics documentation supports measuring the steps in lead generation and identifying meaningful actions as key events. FTC advertising guidance emphasizes truthful, non-deceptive claims and evidence for advertising statements.

Google Analytics lead generation: <https://support.google.com/analytics/answer/12941105>

Google Analytics key events: <https://support.google.com/analytics/answer/12946393>

FTC Advertising FAQ: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/advertising-faqs-guide-small-business>